

BARAKA TINEYI HOMODZA

Game Programmer · Unreal Engine 5 & Unity

Harare, Zimbabwe · UTC+2 · Open to remote & relocation

homodza1@gmail.com · +263 77 113 3966 · [linkedin.com/in/baraka-homodza](https://www.linkedin.com/in/baraka-homodza) · github.com/bababuyi · bababuyi.github.io

SUMMARY

Game programmer working in Unreal Engine 5 (C++ & Blueprints) and Unity (C#) across gameplay systems, enemy AI, and editor tooling. Commissioned solo developer of *Chengetedzo*, a financial-literacy simulation built for Aubik Business Solutions, to be published within a financial-education product. Led and onboarded a cohort of 12 programming interns at Nimbus Games (Kuala Lumpur).

WORK EXPERIENCE

Nimbus Games — Tech Intern Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia · Jul–Nov 2024

- Programmed puzzle systems, gameplay mechanics, and NPC behaviour in Unreal Engine 5 for an unannounced title (under NDA).
- Selected to lead a cohort of 12 incoming programming interns for the final 2.5 months — onboarded them in UE5 and guided design, planning, and development of an initial game prototype under the studio's Chief Creative Director.
- Playtested and gave QA feedback on studio titles *Parasomnia* and *Anachron*.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Chengetedzo — Financial Literacy Simulation (Unity, C#) Jan–Apr 2026 · feature work ongoing

Solo Programmer & Designer · art commissioned from Bill Masuku

- Commissioned by Aubik Business Solutions: a mobile simulation of Zimbabwean household finance, to be published as part of a financial-education product alongside an AI insurance chatbot.
- Built a 24-month simulation with 3 playable profiles, 100+ weighted events with seasonal filters and event chains, 8 insurance types with waiting periods and deductibles, and loan/savings systems.
- Implemented JSON save persistence, a financial-momentum scoring system, contextual mentor guidance, and a headless simulation mode for automated stress-testing.

github.com/bababuyi/Chengetedzo · babazw.itch.io/chengetedzo

Reflection of the Mind — Narrative Puzzle Game (Unreal Engine 5.5) Mar–Jul 2025 · C++ rework in progress

Solo Developer — programming, design, narrative, art (final-year project)

- Fully playable vertical slice (Chapter 1, three acts) of a psychological therapy game.
- Built a data-driven branching dialogue system on DataTables with per-choice trust deltas; persistent trust state branches the narrative per act.
- Created five reusable UMG puzzle widgets triggered directly from dialogue rows.
- Currently migrating systems from Widget Blueprints to C++ with Blueprints.

github.com/bababuyi/Reflection-Of-The-Mind

CatBurglar — Stealth AI Prototype (Unity) Apr–May 2026

Solo — AI Programmer & Designer

- Built two interacting FSM agents: an 8-state grandma AI whose window-closing routine doubles as the level timer, and a 7-state dog AI with pinning, carrying, and bark-based alerts that escalate to the grandma.
- Designed escape rules across three animated window types, tying level pacing directly to the AI's routine.

github.com/bababuyi/CatBurglar

Side Step — Mobile Endless Runner (Unity) Team project Jan–Mar 2025 · solo rework Apr–Jul 2026

v1: procedural generation & 3D art · rework: all systems, solo

- Original team project: implemented procedural tile and wall spawning and modelled obstacles and environment assets.
- Solo rework (complete): rewrote nearly all systems — event-driven managers, adaptive difficulty with anti-frustration pacing, a two-stage health model, four power-ups with a 10-level upgrade shop, and persistent progression; remodelled assets and added new environment props in Blender; refined a teammate's curved-world shader.

github.com/bababuyi/EtiqaEndlessRunner · babazw.itch.io/side-step

Unity Scene Auditor — Editor Tool (C#) Feb 2026 – present

Tools Programmer

- Editor extension that exports scene hierarchies, transforms, components, and public script variables to text — built during Chengetedzo development to debug reference errors and diff scenes; now used across projects and actively extended.

github.com/bababuyi/UnitySceneAuditor

EDUCATION

BSc (Hons) Computer Games Development

Graduated April 2026

Dual award: Asia Pacific University (Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia) & De Montfort University (UK)

Second Class Upper Honours · CGPA 3.29 / 4.0

SKILLS

Programming Languages: C++, C#, Python

Engines: Unreal Engine 5 (C++ & Blueprints), Unity

Gameplay & Systems: Enemy AI & finite state machines, branching dialogue, puzzle mechanics, procedural generation, simulation & economy systems, save/persistence

Specialisations: UI systems (UMG & Unity UI), editor tooling, data-driven design (DataTables, ScriptableObjects), mobile development, hard-surface 3D modelling (Blender)

Tools: Git / GitHub, Perforce, Blender

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Panelist — Button Bash Game Development Conference (March 2026).
- Exchange student — Rotary E-Club District 9210, Brazil (2019–2020).
- Volunteer audio engineer — River of Life Church: live sound & media (2016–2022, 2026–present).

LANGUAGES

English (fluent) · Shona (fluent) · Brazilian Portuguese (fluent) · Spanish (basic)

REFERENCES

Jacob Sow Tian You <i>Senior Lecturer, School of Computing, Engineering & Technology, Asia Pacific University</i> Email: Jacob.sow@apu.edu.my Office: 03-3992 5212 Mobile: +60 12-750 3557	Sharizal Pujahas <i>Lecturer, Creative Interactive Technology, School of Computing & Technology, Asia Pacific University</i> Email: Sharizal.pujahaas@apu.edu.my Office: +6 03-8996 1000 Mobile: +60 17-379 0426
Kudakwashe Sombi <i>Sound and Media Co-ordinator, River of Life Church, Harare</i> Email: Kuda@riveroflifechurch.co.zw Mobile: +263 77-506 7656	Joseph Teng <i>Co-founder, CCD, Nimbus Games</i> Email: joseph@nimbusgames.dev